

at no extra cost, at a time when texting was hugely popular; plus the ability to share files, and chat securely with anyone across the globe (again at no extra cost) was just an unbeatable proposition a few years ago.

With BlackBerry OS 7, BBM was upgraded to be able to make voice calls (over Wi-Fi connections). With BlackBerry 10, BBM is equipped with the ability to make both voice and video calls, and over 3G networks, as well as Wi-Fi. BlackBerry have also announced that BBM will soon be available for Android and iOS as well, which will make it a messaging platform to be reckoned with, and is by far the most interesting development

from BlackBerry. By the time you read this book, in fact, BBM for iOS and Android might already be available.

Currently, you need a BlackBerry ID on a BlackBerry phone to be able to use BBM. When you start up your new phone, and open BBM, you will automatically be prompted to get one, or to log in with an existing BlackBerry ID. Once this is done, you will be asked to either connect your BBM profile with a contact (yourself) or to save a new contact (again your own details). You can add a profile photo, and will be prompted to add a profile name (nickname that others see). Once all of this is done, you're ready to start chatting.

You can invite people using their email address, phone number or BlackBerry PIN.

By default, BBM opens to recent chats. The first time, though it will open to your blank BBM contact list, and suggest you add more. Using the menu on the bottom left you can toggle between Chats, Contacts, Groups, Updates and Invites.

On the Contacts screen, just tap on a person to start a chat. You have all the standard options here, including a list of emoticons you can include in your text. At the bottom of the chat window you have a few icons. The first is the Invite More button, which allows you to add more people to this chat, and thus have a group conversation. This is different from Groups,

